

AZ.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document you will meet, named as the agency names it — the letter that answers any "varies locally" question in thirty days — and the things Arizona never asks you for.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Arizona adopts no statewide residential building code — every code that binds a house is adopted locally, by ordinance, and the edition on your permit is whatever your city or county's adopting ordinance says it is. What is **not** local: a county building permit is required by statute for any construction over \$1,000, and inside a city the city's own permit ordinance governs; the owner-builder exemption, the signed statement you file with every permit application, the septic general permit and the well rules are all state law and apply whether or not anyone will ever inspect the framing. The unit is the **jurisdiction** — a city inside a county routinely differs from the county around it, and the city has statutory permit clocks the county does not. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. Form names and revision dates were read from the agencies' and jurisdictions' own current documents in September 2026. Where no form number is published, this document says so rather than inventing one.

THE DOCUMENTS FIXED BY STATE LAW

Named as the statute, rule or agency names it

Document	What it is	When
The exemption statement Every permit application	Signed, on the application: the basis of your exemption (§ 32-1121(A)(5)) and "the name and license number of any general, mechanical, electrical or plumbing contractor who will be employed on the work" (A.R.S. § 32-1169(A)). The counter "may require" the Registrar's signature verifying the exemption. A false statement is unsworn falsification ((B)). Local names: Tucson and Peoria "Owner/Builder Affidavit"; Scottsdale "Owner-Builder Declaration"; Lake Havasu City "Owner/Builder Certification" (notarized); Buckeye and Santa Cruz County "Owner Builder Form"; Glendale "verification"; Casa Grande an affirmation; Sierra Vista an "Owner App" per trade; La Paz "Owner's Acknowledgment & Verification of Information"; Gila "Owner Builder Statement"; Mohave a checkbox on the application	At application; before it, the licensed-sub list

Named as the statute, rule or agency names it

Document	What it is	When
The recorded deed County recorder	A deed or contract for conveyance "recorded with the county recorder" in a natural person's name "Prior to commencement of the construction" (A.R.S. § 33-1002(A)(2)(a)). The document that switches off the one-year presumption and the subcontractor lien. Keep the instrument number on the AZ.0 cover	Before the first shovel
Preliminary twenty-day notice From each supplier and non-wage sub	"Except for a person performing actual labor for wages, every person who furnishes labor, professional services, materials ... shall, as a necessary prerequisite to the validity of any claim of lien, serve the owner ... with a written preliminary twenty day notice" (A.R.S. § 33-992.01(B)). File every one; it is your lien ledger. Under the owner-occupant shield only a party with a direct written contract with you can lien at all	Within 20 days of first furnishing
The contract A.R.S. § 32-1158	Every contract over \$1,000 with a contractor carries the § 32-1158(A) list (AZ.1): parties, license number, jobsite, dates, the work, total price with taxes, deposit, progress payments and their stages, and the Registrar complaint notice in ten-point bold. You are owed "a legible copy of all documents signed and a written and signed receipt for ... any cash paid" ((B))	Before work; copies kept
Registrar license search · complaint · recovery-fund claim roc.az.gov	Verify the license on the contract date, first-payment date and start date (A.R.S. § 32-1132(C)). A written complaint on a new home "within two years after the earlier of the close of escrow or actual occupancy" (§ 32-1162(A)(1)). The fund pays an occupying owner for damage by a <i>licensed</i> residential contractor (§ 32-1132(B)(1))	Before hiring; within two years of moving in
Notice of Intent to Discharge ADEQ form DWS 402, rev. April 2025 — filed with the delegated county	The septic application, with the site investigation and design. Leads to the Construction Authorization (no construction before it; two years to finish), then on your Request for Discharge Authorization — final site plan, tank watertightness certification, and for an alternative system the installer's ROC number and the designer's Certificate of Completion — to the Discharge Authorization (A.A.C. R18-9-A301(D); A309(C))	Before the footprint is final
Property-line setback waiver Recorded — La Paz County posts a form	Reduces the 50-ft septic-to-line setback on a well-served lot to as little as 5 ft where the neighbor agrees "as evidenced by an appropriately recorded document" to keep any new well 100 ft from your works (A.A.C. R18-9-A312(C), row 2). La Paz's form: both owners sign, notarized, recorded within 30 days "or the waiver is null and void"	With the Notice of Intent, if needed

Named as the statute, rule or agency names it

Document	What it is	When
Transfer of ownership inspection · Notice of Transfer ADEQ-qualified inspector; buyer files	Within six months before a sale the seller retains a qualified inspector; the Report of Inspection must show the tank was pumped unless the system went into service within the prior 12 months; the buyer files a Notice of Transfer with the county "within 15 calendar days after the property transfer" (A.A.C. R18-9-A316)	At sale
Notice of Intention to Drill ADWR	Signed by the owner or lessee (A.A.C. R12-15-809); fee \$150, or \$100 for a domestic well at 35 gpm or less outside an AMA or INA (A.R.S. § 45-596(L)); on five acres or less, with the well site plan carrying "written approval by the county health authority" ((F)). Returns the drilling card within 15 days ((D)); the well must be completed within a year ((E))	Before the rig; site plan first
Single well license ADWR — application and examination	For an owner drilling an exempt well on their own land: "No fee may be charged" (A.R.S. § 45-595(D)). The application lists the rig, the design, the helpers and whether they are paid; the exam is offered at least six times a year; passing grade 70 percent; valid one year for one well at one location (A.A.C. R12-15-807)	Before drilling it yourself
Well completion reports ADWR	The driller's within 30 days of completion; yours within 30 days after the pump is installed — equipment, the 4-hour tested capacity, drawdown, static level (A.R.S. § 45-600)	30 days after each event
Independent-contractor agreement · sole-proprietor waiver Workers' compensation	A written agreement with the eight statutory statements, disclosing that the contractor is not entitled to workers' compensation from you, "creates a rebuttable presumption of an independent contractor relationship" (A.R.S. § 23-902(D)); a sole proprietor may sign the statutory waiver (§ 23-961(N)). Have both from anyone not on a licensed contractor's payroll	Before the first paid day
The recorded opt-out notice Cochise; Coconino	Cochise: "a notice that a permit has been issued pursuant to the provisions of this article shall be recorded with the County Recorder" (OBA Sec. 6). Coconino AMMP: a recorded "Notice of Disclosure Statement." Both follow the title	At permit issuance
Pool safety notice DHS-approved	Anyone entering "an agreement to build a swimming pool" must give the buyer the notice (A.R.S. § 36-1681(E)); the barrier rules are in AZ.2	With any pool contract

THE LOCAL DOCUMENTS — WHAT YOURS CALLS THEM

Each city and county issues its own paperwork under its own names, and there is no statewide vocabulary for it. Write in what yours calls them, and the date you received the § 9-836 / § 11-1606 handout.

What my jurisdiction calls each document

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Building permit application , and the § 32-1169 statement — separate form, or a block on the application? Called _____ Separate? _____		
☐	The handout — steps, time frames, contact, website, clarification notice (§ 9-836(A); § 11-1606): Received _____ Time frames stated _____		
☐	Zoning use permit and the § 11-815(B) sketch: Called _____ Issued by _____		
☐	Floodplain development permit , if in a mapped hazard area: Called _____ Administrator _____		
☐	Driveway approach / encroachment permit , and the 911 address application : Called _____ Road authority _____ 911 form _____ Issued by _____		
☐	Certificate of occupancy — ask whether one is issued on my permit, because under Greenlee, Cochise Option 2 and the Coconino AMMP there is none: Answer _____		

WHAT NEEDS NO PERMIT — AND WHAT ARIZONA DOES NOT REQUIRE

Two statutory floors, neither of which reaches a house. The county building permit is for construction "exceeding a cost of \$1,000" (A.R.S. § 11-321(A)); the zoning permit is not required "for repairs or improvements of a value not exceeding five hundred dollars" (§ 11-815(B)). The county code article does not apply to construction "incidental to" farming, ranching and the like (§ 11-865(A)(1)) — a barn, not a dwelling. Everything else is the locally adopted IRC R105.2 list as amended; ask for it.

And what Arizona does not require, which owner-builders arriving from other states routinely budget for:

- **A state trade license for you.** Arizona licenses contractors only; "Only contractors as defined in this section are licensed and regulated by this chapter" (A.R.S. § 32-1101(B)), and an owner under § 32-1121(A)(5) is expressly not a residential contractor (§ 32-1101(A)(10)(b)). Title 32 has no electrician's or plumber's chapter.
- **Residential fire sprinklers.** No city or county may require them in a one- or two-family house, or reach them through an access-road rule (A.R.S. § 9-807; § 9-808; § 11-861(E), (G)).
- **A statewide energy code, insulation table or climate-zone map.** The state standard reaches public capital projects only (A.R.S. § 34-451); Maricopa County's chapter is voluntary and five counties have none.
- **A business or transaction-privilege-tax license as a condition of your permit** (A.R.S. § 9-467(E); § 11-321(E)); **a permit for the prior owner's unpermitted work** before yours issues, except for health and safety (§ 9-467(F); § 11-321(H)); **an engineer's stamp on a solar permit** without a written reason (§ 9-468; § 11-323).
- **A "once per 24 months," "once per five years" or "live in it two years" rule.** None is in § 32-1121. The five-year limit is Cochise County's, on its opt-out permit only.
- **A statewide inspection list, permit life, fee schedule or review time for a county permit.** None exists; the only county clock is inspections "at the earliest reasonable time" (§ 11-863(B)).

WHAT YOU MAY DO YOURSELF — AND THE ONE THAT NEEDS AN EXAM

Arizona is generous about owner-performed work — here is the map

Task	May you?	Why
Act as your own builder; wire and plumb your own house	Yes, at the state level	A.R.S. § 32-1121(A)(5); § 32-1101(A)(10)(b), (B) — the local variable is whether the counter issues the trade permit, and rentals are the line
Install a conventional septic system	Yes	A.A.C. R18-9-A309(C)(1) asks for no installer license number; the county inspects before backfill and you certify the tank watertightness test
Install an alternative septic system	No	A.A.C. R18-9-A309(C)(2) requires "the name of the installation contractor and the Registrar of Contractor's license number" and a designer's Certificate of Completion
Do the site investigation or perc test	No	A.A.C. R18-9-A310(H) — a registered engineer, geologist or sanitarian, or a holder of a Department-recognized training certificate
Drill your own exempt well	Yes — after the exam	A.R.S. § 45-595(D): a single well license, no fee; A.A.C. R12-15-807: application, examination at 70 percent, one well, one year. Otherwise a licensed driller (§ 45-595(A))

Arizona is generous about owner-performed work — here is the map

Task	May you?	Why
Do the gas connection and fire-safety wiring	You, or a licensed contractor — not a helper	A.R.S. § 32-1121(D) closes the casual and handyman exemptions to fuel-gas and fire-safety work; paragraph (5) is untouched

THE THIRTY-DAY CLARIFICATION LETTER — A.R.S. § 9-839 / § 11-1609

The one form you write. A city or county "shall respond within thirty days of the receipt of the written request with a written explanation of its interpretation or application" (A.R.S. § 9-839; § 11-1609) — and both statutes list what the request must contain. Every "it depends on your jurisdiction" in this kit — the code edition and grace period, the inspection list, the Registrar's signature, the county's actual review time — becomes a dated written answer. Draft it here, then send it.

Request for clarification — the five statutory elements

Element	Write here
1. Your name and address	
2. The statute, ordinance or code provision you need clarified — by section number	
3. The relevant facts — parcel, zoning, what you propose to build and how	
4. Your proposed interpretation — say what you believe the provision means for your parcel	
5. Whether the issue is pending on an existing application, and which	
Sent · to · received · answered	

Everything cited here is free to read. Statutes are at azleg.gov, one section per page (azleg.gov/ars/32/01121.htm — title unpadded, section padded to five digits). Rules are the Arizona Administrative Code, one PDF per chapter at apps.azsos.gov and reproduced section by section at law.cornell.edu/regulations/arizona. **One warning:** the Registrar of Contractors licenses contractors, not owners, and it is not your building department — the city or county is. Read September 2026.